

Non-traditional branding
Food making and font design
Moving image

https://youtu.be/914hGRX4J6E

DODO RCASU 03

New Staff Dining

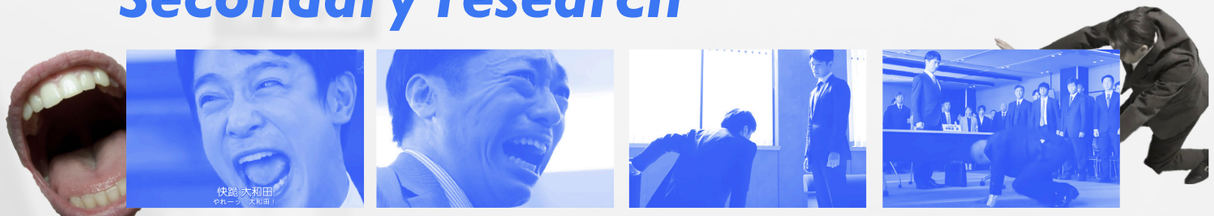
Inspiration

New Staff Dining is an Asian-themed restaurant within a corporate establishment, whose design synthesises traditional Asian culinary motifs with contemporary workplace iconography. Through visual symbols representing signature Asian set menus, it deconstructs the phenomena of sycophancy, psychological manipulation, and unwritten rules prevalent within Asian corporate cultures.



Welcome to the working jungle!

Secondary research



Hanzawa Naoki



Quits! I fired that exploitative company

Tokyo Sonata

Misaeng: Incomplete Life

Examples include an excessive emphasis on compliance, hierarchical superiority complexes among leadership, fixed catchphrases among colleagues, excessive flattery by subordinates seeking career advantages, and promotions and career advancement based on connections rather than ability. Among these, the most frequently cited issue is ***PUA cultrue.***

Primary research

A 30-year-old female teacher from a university design college in China



At the university where I once taught, I encountered particularly egregious instances of manipulation and coercion. Performance evaluations no longer prioritised academic attendance but instead centred on one's standing within the leadership hierarchy.

Within this unspoken system, verbal and psychological abuse found no outlet for redress, leaving one feeling as though forced to consume spoiled fare.

Food experiment

1.Obtain ingredients:
To obtain sea urchin shells, I dined at a Japanese restaurant serving seafood.



The cooked octopus looks even ***more attractive.***

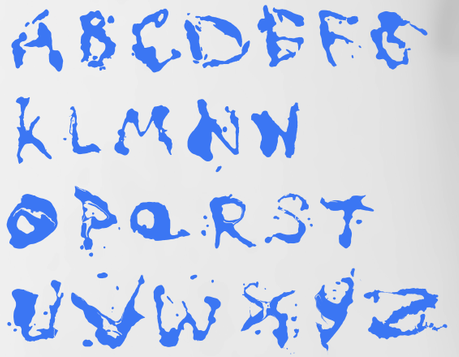
2.Food Experiment:
I dissolved the white sugar by boiling it, I didn't time the pouring out quite right, the syrup solidified with a very dark colour.



3.Store food

Therefore, I devised an induction meal ritual for newcomers to the Asian workplace to satirise the unwritten rules of the Asian workplace.

Typeface design





The Sample of Typefaces:

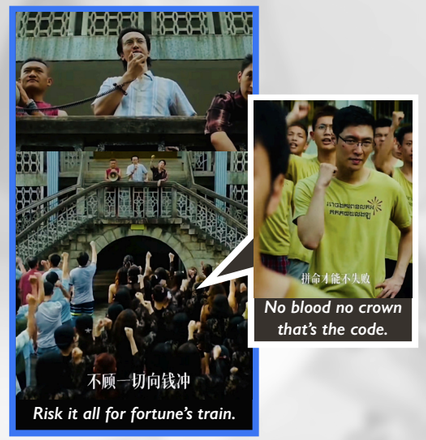


3. Table runner

The table runner employs collage elements: telephone cables, thumbtacks, wastepaper baskets, files, and printers represent essential workplace tools. The inclusion of ***bodily organ forms*** *symbolises the oppressed* ***helplessness of employees*** *and the aloof, ruthless commanding posture of the tie-wearing hierarchy.*

The table runner's design draws inspiration from the film ***No More Bets,*** *centred on telecommunications fraud. In the film, the ringleader of the scam syndicate delivers a brainwashing speech prioritising profit over ethics to drive his employees into working day and night without reason:*

Want success? Get insane. Risk it all for fortune's train.
Three gens reap what you sow. No blood no crown that's the code.





'Want success? Get insane': *Reflects the excessive pursuit of money in the workplace that causes employees to lose their rationality.*

'Risk it all for fortune's train': *Embodies the competitive culture in the workplace that disregards personal health.*

'Three gens reap what you sow': *Emphasises short-term sacrifice for long-term wealth, neglecting sustained effort.*

'No blood no crown that's the code': *Reveals the fear of failure in the workplace and the manipulation of employees.*





4. Dining menu

The table runner's design draws inspiration from the film No More Bets, centred on telecommunications fraud. In the film, the ringleader of the scam syndicate delivers a brainwashing speech prioritising profit over ethics to drive his employees into working day and night without reason:





5. Dining tableware



Through cuisine, it poses a silent yet incisive challenge to the toxicity of workplace culture, compelling viewers to consider: 'Are we willingly swallowing these unspoken rules?'

https://youtu.be/9I4hGRX4J6E

6. Dining tie

The tie, as a mandatory item of attire for workplace employees, exerts considerable constraint. Represent three distinct states of workplace bullying.





1. Smiling service urchin

2. The clique

3. Psycho sushi

7. Dining napkin





